

Word family: **understand / understands / understood / understanding / understandable / understandably / misunderstanding / misunderstand**

Base word: understand

Past tense / past participle: **understood**

Part of speech: mainly **verb**

Related forms:

* **understand** (v.) — 明白；理解；了解

* **understood** (adj./participle) — 被理解的；心照不宣的

* **understanding** (n.) — 理解；認識；共識

* **understanding** (adj.) — 體諒人的；善解人意的

* **understandable** (adj.) — 可以理解的；情有可原的

* **understandably** (adv.) — 可以理解地；情有可原地

* **misunderstand** (v.) — 誤解

* **misunderstanding** (n.) — 誤會；誤解

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **understand something**

* **understand someone**

* **understand why/how/what... **

* **understand that... **

* **understand someone correctly**

* **make yourself understood**

* **be understood**

* **as I understand it**

* **I understand**

* **I understand you to mean... **

* **it is understood that... **

* **come to understand**

* **have an understanding of**

* **reach an understanding**

* **on the understanding that... **

* **mutual understanding**

* **be understanding**

* **understandable reaction**

* **misunderstand someone**

* **a misunderstanding**

Meaning in this passage

> He showed me that a good question could open a door, and that one event could be

****understood from different angles**.**

Here, ****understood**** means:

**interpreted or viewed in a particular way — 被理解；被解讀；從某個角度看待**

The speaker means that one historical event does not always have only one possible interpretation. Different people may understand its causes, significance, or consequences differently.

****中文翻譯：****

他讓我明白，一個好的問題可以打開一道門，而同一件事其實可以****從不同角度去理解****。

So here:

**understand something from a different angle = 從另一個觀點或角度解讀某件事**

1. **understand something (明白；理解) — 明白；理解**

This is the central meaning.

Practice 1

> I don't ****understand this question****.

我不****明白這條問題****。

Practice 2

> She ****understands the basic idea****.

她****明白這個基本概念****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****understand something = 知道某件事的意思、原理、原因或運作方式****

2. **understand how / why / what... — 明白怎樣 / 為甚麼 / 甚麼**

Practice 1

> He helped us ****understand why the event happened****.

他幫助我們**明白為甚麼這件事會發生**。

Practice 2

> I finally **understand how the system works**.

我終於**明白這個系統怎樣運作**。

MCQ-ready definition:

understand how/why/what... = 明白某件事的方式、原因或內容

3. **understand that... — 明白 / 知道某件事是真的**

Practice 1

> I **understand that the meeting has been cancelled**.

我**知道會議已經取消**。

Practice 2

> We need to **understand that mistakes are part of learning**.

我們需要**明白犯錯是學習的一部分**。

MCQ-ready definition:

understand that... = 明白或接受某件事實、情況或原則

4. **understand someone — 明白某人的意思 / 想法**

Practice 1

> I **understand what you're saying**.

我**明白你在說甚麼**。

Practice 2

> She speaks quickly, but I can still **understand her**.

她說得很快，但我仍然**聽得明白她說甚麼**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****understand someone = 明白某人所說的內容、意圖或想表達的意思****

5. ****understand someone (理解某人的感受 / 處境) — 理解；體諒****

A major interpersonal extension.

Practice 1

> I really ****understand how you feel****.

我真的****明白你的感受****。

Practice 2

> She always tries to ****understand her students****.

她總會嘗試****理解學生的處境和感受****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****understand someone = 能夠體會某人的感受、動機或處境****

6. ****understand something from a particular angle — 從某角度理解 / 解讀****

This is the exact passage sense.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> One event could be ****understood from different angles****.

同一件事可以****從不同角度理解****。

Practice 2

> The conflict can be ****understood from both sides****.

這場衝突可以****從雙方角度去理解****。

Practice 3

> The story becomes more interesting when it is ****understood from the child's point of view****.

如果**從孩子的角度去理解**，這個故事會變得更有趣。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****understand something from an angle/point of view = 從某種立場、觀點或解釋框架來看待某事****

7. ****understand something as something — 把.....理解為.....****

Practice 1

> I ****understood his silence as disagreement****.

我把他的沉默****理解為不同意****。

Practice 2

> The remark could be ****understood as a warning****.

那句話可以被****理解為警告****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****understand X as Y = 把 X 解讀、理解成 Y****

8. ****be understood to mean... — 被理解為.....；被認為意思是.....****

Practice 1

> His comment was ****understood to mean that he would resign****.

他的說話被****理解為他將會辭職****。

Practice 2

> The phrase is generally ****understood to mean**** “be careful.”

這個短語一般被****理解為****「要小心」。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be understood to mean X = 普遍被解讀為有 X 的意思****

9. **understand someone to mean... — 理解某人的意思是.....**

Practice 1

> I **understood you to mean** that the lesson was cancelled.

我理解你的意思是**課堂取消了**。

Practice 2

> Did I **understand you to mean** that you're leaving?

我有沒有理解錯——你的意思是你要離開？

MCQ-ready definition:

understand someone to mean X = 把某人的說話理解成 X 這個意思

10. **make yourself understood — 讓別人明白自己的意思**

Practice 1

> Her English is basic, but she can **make herself understood**.

她的英文很基本，但她能夠**讓別人明白自己的意思**。

Practice 2

> Speak slowly so you can **make yourself understood**.

說慢一點，讓別人可以**聽明白你的意思**。

MCQ-ready definition:

make yourself understood = 成功把自己的意思表達清楚，令別人明白

11. **come to understand — 逐漸明白**

Practice 1

> I gradually **came to understand** why he taught that way.

我逐漸**明白**他為甚麼那樣教。

Practice 2

> She **came to understand** the importance of patience.

她後來逐漸**明白耐性的重要性**。

MCQ-ready definition:

come to understand = 經過時間、經驗或思考後逐漸明白某事

12. **as I understand it** — 據我理解；照我的理解

Practice 1

> **As I understand it**, the lesson has been moved to Friday.

據我理解，課堂已改到星期五。

Practice 2

> **As I understand it**, no final decision has been made.

照我的理解，目前還沒有最終決定。

MCQ-ready definition:

as I understand it = 根據自己目前掌握的理解或資訊

13. **I understand** (表示已收到 / 明白) — 我明白；知道了

Practice 1

> "Please submit it by Friday."

> **"I understand."**

「請在星期五前提交。」

「**我明白了。**」

Practice 2

> **I understand** what I need to do.

我**知道自己需要做甚麼**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****I understand = 表示自己已明白剛才的資訊、要求或解釋****

14. ****I understand... (據聞 / 我得知) — 我聽說 ; 據我所知****

A more formal conversational use.

Practice 1

> ****I understand you're leaving the company****.

我****聽說你要離開公司****。

Practice 2

> ****I understand that Mr Chan taught here for many years****.

我****聽說 / 得知****陳老師曾在這裏任教多年。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****I understand that... = 表示自己從別處得知某項資訊，而不是親自證實****

15. ****it is understood that... — 據了解 ; 大家普遍認為****

Formal/reporting style.

Practice 1

> ****It is understood that**** the decision will be announced tomorrow.

****據了解****，該決定將於明天公布。

Practice 2

> ****It is understood that**** both sides have agreed.

****據悉****，雙方已達成協議。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****it is understood that... = 以較正式方式表示某消息被普遍認為是真實，但未必由官方直接確認****

16. **understanding (理解 ; 認識) — 理解 ; 了解程度**

Practice 1

> She has a good **understanding of history**.

她對歷史有很好的**理解**。

Practice 2

> Reading widely can deepen your **understanding**.

廣泛閱讀可以加深你的**理解**。

MCQ-ready definition:

understanding = 對某個主題、概念或情況掌握和理解的程度

17. **have an understanding of something — 對.....有認識 / 理解**

Practice 1

> Students need a basic **understanding of the topic**.

學生需要對這個課題有基本的**理解**。

Practice 2

> He has a deep **understanding of human behaviour**.

他對人類行為有深入**認識**。

MCQ-ready definition:

have an understanding of X = 對 X 的原理、內容或情況有一定掌握

18. **understanding (共識 ; 協議) — 共識 ; 諒解**

A genuinely distinct noun sense.

Practice 1

> We reached an **understanding**.

我們達成了**共識 / 諒解**。

Practice 2

> There was a clear **understanding** between the two sides.

雙方之間有明確的**共識**。

MCQ-ready definition:

understanding = 雙方對某件事達成的共同認識或非正式協議

19. **reach / come to an understanding — 達成共識**

Practice 1

> After a long discussion, they **reached an understanding**.

經過長時間討論後，他們**達成了共識**。

Practice 2

> We need to **come to an understanding** about the schedule.

我們需要就時間表**達成共識**。

MCQ-ready definition:

reach an understanding = 經討論後在某件事上取得共同意見或協議

20. **on the understanding that... — 在.....的條件 / 共識下**

A useful formal expression.

Practice 1

> I agreed **on the understanding that** the work would be finished by Friday.

我是在**大家都同意工作會於星期五前完成的前提下**答應的。

Practice 2

> She joined the project **on the understanding that** she could work remotely.

她是在**可以遙距工作的條件下**加入這個項目的。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****on the understanding that... = 在雙方都接受某項條件或前提的情況下****

21. ****mutual understanding — 相互理解****

Practice 1

> Good communication builds ****mutual understanding****.

良好溝通可以建立****相互理解****。

Practice 2

> The discussion improved ****mutual understanding**** between the two groups.

這場討論改善了兩個群體之間的****相互了解****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****mutual understanding = 雙方彼此理解對方的想法、需要或立場****

22. ****understanding (adjective : 體諒人的) — 善解人意的 ; 體諒人的****

Practice 1

> She is a very ****understanding teacher****.

她是一位非常****善解人意的老師****。

Practice 2

> My manager was ****understanding**** about the mistake.

我的經理對這個錯誤很****體諒****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****understanding = 願意考慮別人的處境、感受和困難，不輕易批評****

23. **understandable — 可以理解的；情有可原的**

Practice 1

> Her reaction was completely **understandable**.

她的反應完全**可以理解 / 情有可原**。

Practice 2

> It's **understandable** that he felt nervous.

他感到緊張是**可以理解的**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****understandable = 有合理原因，因此別人能夠理解或接受的****

24. **understandable (容易理解的) — 易明的**

A second useful adjective use.

Practice 1

> The teacher explained the idea in an **understandable way**.

老師用**容易明白的方式**解釋這個概念。

Practice 2

> The instructions are clear and **understandable**.

指示很清楚，而且**容易理解**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****understandable = 表達得清楚，容易被人理解的****

25. **understandably — 可以理解地；情有可原地**

Practice 1

> She was **understandably upset**.

她感到不開心是**完全可以理解的**。

Practice 2

> The students were **understandably nervous** before the exam.

考試前，學生感到緊張也是**情有可原的**。

MCQ-ready definition:

understandably = 因為有合理原因，所以某種反應並不令人意外

26. **misunderstand — 誤解；聽錯 / 理解錯**

Practice 1

> You **misunderstood what I said**.

你**誤解了我的意思**。

Practice 2

> Don't **misunderstand me**—I'm not criticizing you.

不要**誤會我**——我不是在批評你。

MCQ-ready definition:

misunderstand = 把某人的說話、意圖或某件事理解錯誤

27. **misunderstanding (誤解) — 誤解；理解錯誤**

Practice 1

> There was a **misunderstanding about the instructions**.

大家對指示有一個**誤解**。

Practice 2

> The problem came from a **misunderstanding of the rule**.

問題源於對規則的**錯誤理解**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****misunderstanding = 對某件事的意思、情況或意圖理解錯誤****

28. ****misunderstanding (人際誤會) — 誤會****

Practice 1

> It was all a ****misunderstanding****.

整件事只是一場****誤會****。

Practice 2

> They had an argument because of a ****misunderstanding****.

他們因為一場****誤會****而爭執。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****misunderstanding = 因雙方錯誤理解對方的說話或意圖而產生的誤會或衝突****

29. ****be misunderstood — 被誤解****

Practice 1

> His comment was ****misunderstood****.

他的說話被****誤解了****。

Practice 2

> She often feels ****misunderstood****.

她經常覺得自己****不被理解 / 被人誤會****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be misunderstood = 自己的意思、個性或行為被別人錯誤理解****

Important distinction 1: ****understand vs know****

Very important.

know

have information.

understand

grasp the meaning, reason, or mechanism.

> I know the date.

我知道日期。

> I understand why it happened.

我明白事情為甚麼發生。

You can **know a fact without understanding it**.

Important distinction 2: **understand vs learn**

learn

acquire new knowledge or skill.

understand

successfully grasp it.

> I learned about the event.

我學到了這件歷史事件。

> I understood why it mattered.

我明白它為甚麼重要。

Learning does not automatically guarantee understanding.

Important distinction 3: **understand vs remember**

remember

retain or recall information.

understand

grasp meaning.

This distinction is particularly important in your teacher passage:

> memorising dates ≠ understanding history

A student can remember every date and still not understand the event.

Important distinction 4: **understand vs explain**

understand

mental comprehension.

explain

communicate the reasons/meaning to someone else.

You may understand something but struggle to explain it clearly.

Important distinction 5: **understand vs interpret**

understand

broadly grasp meaning.

interpret

choose or develop a particular reading/explanation.

In your passage:

> understood from different angles

comes quite close to:

> interpreted from different perspectives.

But ****understand**** sounds broader and more learner-friendly.

Important distinction 6: ****understand vs realize****

****understand****

grasp meaning/reason.

****realize****

become aware that something is true.

> I understand how it works.

我明白它怎樣運作。

> I realized I was wrong.

我意識到自己錯了。

Important distinction 7: ****understand vs appreciate****

****understand****

grasp mentally.

****appreciate****

can mean understand the importance/difficulty of something, often with emotional recognition.

> I understand the problem.

我明白問題。

> I appreciate how difficult this is.

我明白 / 體會這有多困難。

Important distinction 8: ****understand a person vs agree with a person****

Understanding someone's position does ****not**** mean agreeing with it.

> I understand why he thinks that, but I disagree.

我明白他為甚麼這樣想，但我不同意。

This distinction is especially useful for historical analysis.

Important distinction 9: ****understand from X vs understand X****

****understand X****

general comprehension.

****understand X from a particular angle****

adds the interpretive perspective.

> understand the event

理解事件

> understand the event from the workers' perspective

從工人的角度理解事件

Important distinction 10: ****I understand = I comprehend vs I hear/learn****

Comprehension

> I understand the rule.

我明白規則。

Reported information

> I understand he's leaving.

我聽說 / 得知他要離開。

Context determines the meaning.

Important distinction 11: **understanding noun vs understanding adjective**

Noun

> a deep **understanding** of history

對歷史的深入理解

Adjective

> an **understanding** teacher

一位善解人意的老師

Same form, different POS and sense.

Important distinction 12: **understanding = knowledge vs understanding = agreement**

Knowledge

> an understanding of science

對科學的理解

Agreement

> reach an understanding

達成共識

This is a genuine lexical distinction.

Important distinction 13: **understanding vs agreement**

understanding

can be informal and may not be written down.

agreement

broader and often more explicit/formal.

> We had an understanding.

我們有默契 / 共識。

> We signed an agreement.

我們簽署了協議。

Important distinction 14: ****understanding vs sympathy****

****understanding****

recognizes someone's reasons and feelings.

****sympathy****

feels concern or sorrow for them.

You can be understanding without necessarily feeling sympathy.

Important distinction 15: ****understandable = easy to understand vs reasonable reaction****

Two useful senses:

Content

> understandable instructions

容易明白的指示

Reaction

> understandable anger

情有可原的憤怒

The first concerns ****clarity****; the second concerns ****justifiability****.

Important distinction 16: ****misunderstand vs mishear****

****mishear****

hear the sounds incorrectly.

****misunderstand****

interpret the meaning incorrectly.

> I misheard “fifteen” as “fifty.”

我把 fifteen 聽成 fifty。

> I misunderstood what she meant.

我誤解了她的意思。

Important distinction 17: ****misunderstanding vs disagreement****

****misunderstanding****

people have understood something incorrectly.

****disagreement****

people understand each other but hold different opinions.

This is a very important distinction.

Important distinction 18: ****understood = past tense vs adjective-like use****

Past tense

> I ****understood**** the lesson.

我明白了課堂內容。

Passive/adjectival

> It is ****understood**** that...

據了解.....

The form is the same, but the grammar differs.

Family-extension note

****Understand**** has a strong semantic core:

**grasp the meaning, reason, situation, or perspective of something**

From that, several major branches develop:

1. ****comprehension****

- * understand a question
- * understand how something works

2. ****interpretation****

- * understand something as X
- * understand something from another angle

3. ****human empathy****

- * understand someone
- * understanding person

4. ****reported knowledge****

- * I understand that...
- * it is understood that...

5. ****shared agreement****

- * an understanding
- * reach an understanding

6. ****reasonableness****

- * understandable
- * understandably

7. ****error branch****

- * misunderstand
- * misunderstanding

The passage uses a particularly important academic extension:

understand an event from different angles

which means **interpret and make sense of the same event from different perspectives**, rather than merely memorizing facts about it.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
-----	-----	-----	
understand something	明白；理解	comprehend	
understand how/why	明白怎樣 / 為甚麼	grasp reason/process	
understand that...	明白.....	grasp fact	
understand someone	明白某人的意思	comprehend person	
understand someone's feelings	理解 / 體諒	empathy	
understand from an angle	從某角度理解	perspective	
understand X as Y	把 X 理解為 Y	interpretation	
be understood to mean	被理解為	interpreted meaning	
make yourself understood	讓人明白自己	communicate successfully	
come to understand	逐漸明白	gradual comprehension	
as I understand it	據我理解	current interpretation	
I understand	我明白	acknowledgement	
I understand that...	我聽說 / 據我所知	reported information	
it is understood that...	據了解	formal reported information	
understanding	理解；認識	comprehension	
understanding of X	對 X 的理解	knowledge	
an understanding	共識；諒解	agreement	
reach an understanding	達成共識	agreement reached	
on the understanding that	在.....前提下	agreed condition	
mutual understanding	相互理解	shared comprehension	
understanding (adj.)	善解人意的	empathetic	
understandable	可以理解的	reasonable/comprehensible	
understandably	情有可原地	reasonably	
misunderstand	誤解	interpret wrongly	
misunderstanding	誤解；誤會	wrong interpretation	
be misunderstood	被誤解	understood wrongly	

For your original sentence

> He showed me that a good question could open a door, and that one event could be
understood from different angles.

Here:

understood = 被理解 / 被解讀

and:

from different angles = 從不同觀點、立場或分析角度

So the full idea is:

同一歷史事件可以從不同人的立場、不同原因、不同後果或不同解釋框架去理解

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 他讓我明白，一個好的問題可以打開一道門，而同一件事其實可以**從不同角度去理解**。

This is one of the central ideas of the whole passage: Mr Chan moved the speaker from
memorising history to **interpreting history**.